

# Film-induced tourism: a bibliometric analysis (1998–2024)

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## Abstract

**Purpose** – This study aims to critically evaluate the scientific evolution of film-induced tourism research from 1998 to 2024, identifying its transformative impact on tourism management and destination marketing. Our study seeks to uncover the pivotal role of audiovisual fiction in shaping tourist behavior, constructing destination images and influencing global travel motivations.

**Design/methodology/approach** – A bibliometric analysis was conducted using the Scopus database, covering 386 documents. The study employed VOSviewer software to map co-authorship networks, keyword co-occurrence and thematic clusters, revealing multidisciplinary contributions and collaboration patterns.

**Findings** – The analysis reveals a steady increase in research activity, with a significant rise in interest after 2020. Two primary research clusters emerge: one focused on tourist motivations and profiles and another on the influence of audiovisual media in shaping destination images. Despite a broad multidisciplinary approach, limited collaboration among researchers and institutions was observed. The findings underline the growing role of film-induced tourism as a strategic tool for destination management and marketing.

**Research limitations/implications** – This study is limited by its exclusive reliance on the Scopus database, which may underrepresent non-English publications and contributions from emerging regions. Additionally, the use of a single bibliometric tool (VOSviewer) may restrict the scope of thematic clustering. Future studies should incorporate alternative databases and complementary analytical tools to enhance coverage and robustness. Despite these limitations, the findings offer valuable insights for advancing international collaboration and interdisciplinary dialog in film-induced tourism research.

**Practical implications** – The study demonstrates that film-induced tourism is an expanding field of research, with a well-established impact on travel motivations and the construction of destination images. However, it still faces significant challenges related to international collaboration and interdisciplinary engagement among researchers and institutions.

**Originality/value** – This work not only highlights emerging trends and gaps in collaboration among researchers and institutions but also provides actionable insights for leveraging media-driven tourism as a strategic tool for sustainable development and competitive advantage in the tourism industry.

**Keywords** Film-induced tourism, Bibliometric analysis, VOSviewer, Audiovisual fiction, Tourism management, Destination branding

**Paper type** Literature review

## 1. Introduction

Hudson and Ritchie perceive the phenomenon of film-induced tourism as a growing sub-type of tourism framed within cultural tourism and conceptualize it as “[...] tourist visits to a destination or attraction as a result of the destination’s being featured on television, video, or the cinema screen” (2006, p. 387). The audiovisual world has revealed itself as a powerful creator of *tourist imaginability* and a configurator of the contemporary urban landscape projected by tourist destinations. It is a “provider of virtual journeys for the enjoyment of all



audiences” and “the most powerful producer of modern mythologies” (Rey-Reguillo, 2007, p. 9), whose creation was once attributed to fictional literature. In this vein, Beeton highlights that “film is to literary tourism what the Boeing 747 was to mainstream tourism – a major booster for mass tourism. We have moved from small, niche based pilgrimage literary tours to the mass (and at times over-full) visitation of film sites” (2006, p. 53). This paper proposes to examine the evolution of researchers’ interest in this phenomenon over the period 1998–2024.

Audiovisual fiction has promoted “the construction of the world as a cinematographic landscape” (Ortiz-Villete, 2007, p. 211), forming in the collective imaginary the current “brands” of cities and territories (“place branding” and “country branding”) and contributing to our cinematographic conception of territory (Puche-Ruiz, 2020). This cinematic image, which acts as a geographical designation of origin and arouses value in the minds of consumers, can resort to trivialization when it does not use the knowledge or affection that hosts feel for their place of origin in the projection of their own image. This aspect is particularly relevant given the concept of “cultural affinity”, used by the UNWTO and Netflix (2021) and understood as “the growing affection and attraction one has towards a particular country or culture displayed on the screen”, which aligns with sustainable tourism practices and the SDGs (particularly with SDGs 8, 16 and 17).

In our postmodern world it is impossible to dissociate tourists from spectators and the latter, progressively, from consumers of digital content who are the real protagonists of mass “media pilgrimages” (Alvarado-Sizzo *et al.*, 2024). Thus, while the former seek to recognize during their trip those images produced by the tourist industry with which they have fed their fantasy (Galí and Donaire, 2003), multi-screen viewers show their desire to (re)visit the places that the audiovisual medium has anticipated over time (vicarious consumption of experiences, according to the term coined by Riley *et al.*, 1992), traveling to the film locations which have captured their imagination. This subjective and cultural conditioning of the tourist gaze has resulted in a conditioning of the choice of destinations (Mayo and Jarvis, 1981), as happened in the past with the gaze originated by literary fiction, and also in a rapid construction of clichés, projecting possible mismatches with the reality of tourist destinations (Aertsen *et al.*, 2022).

In her model on the advance of knowledge in the field of film-induced tourism, Beeton (2011) stresses how, since the emergence of the first authors in the 1990s, research attained academic status at the beginning of the 21st century. This author highlights the progress made in the field of Tourism Studies, mainly interested in understanding the application of film-induced tourism from the perspective of destination marketing. However, she points to the emergence of other areas interested in film-induced tourism at the end of the 2000s (Film Studies and Social Sciences) and identifies that they could provide an in-depth analysis of the phenomenon from a postmodern perspective exploring both identity and the shaping of the myth and fantasy of the tourist.

While there are different works that have recently studied the evolution of the phenomenon of film-induced tourism, highlighting the topics addressed (Nieto-Ferrando *et al.*, 2023), focusing on the authors’ preferred methodology (Puche-Ruiz *et al.*, 2024), on certain geographical areas (Nakayama, 2021), on a specific number of articles (Cardoso *et al.*, 2017) or database (WOS in the case of Yayla and Çatir (2024)), this paper proposes a bibliometric analysis of the object of study during the period 1998–2024 using the Scopus database, to track the evolution of research concerning this phenomenon (Donthu *et al.*, 2021). This approach allows us to assess the current state of knowledge in a more comprehensive way and identify future research trends in this domain. Specifically, we aim to answer the following research questions:

- RQ1. What have been the general trends related to film-induced tourism?
- RQ2. What have been the main thematic areas and the most significant publications addressing film-induced tourism?

- RQ3. Who have been the most prolific authors, journals, institutions, and countries in the research field of film-induced tourism?
- RQ4. What have been the main international cooperation networks among authors, institutions, and countries?
- RQ5. What are the primary current research topics in film-induced tourism?

2. Materials and methods

2.1 Database and bibliometric analysis methodology

In order to answer the research questions, a methodology based on bibliometric analysis has been implemented (see Figure 1). Scientometry or bibliometric analysis uses techniques to identify, organize and analyze metadata to study the evolution of a field of knowledge during a specific period (Rey-Martí *et al.*, 2016). For data collection, Scopus database was selected because:

- (1) It offers a wealth of information about authors, countries and institutions (Donthu *et al.*, 2021). The Scopus ability's to provide detailed citation data and affiliations makes it a valuable tool for mapping scientific collaborations and trends (Bellver *et al.*, 2023; Donthu *et al.*, 2021; Vera-Baceta *et al.*, 2019);
- (2) It encompasses a substantial quantity of articles and journals that adhere to rigorous peer-reviewed scientific quality standards (Bellver *et al.*, 2023; Donthu *et al.*, 2021);
- (3) Even though it has a high correlation with Web of Science, the coverage of Scopus is greater (Mongeon and Paul-Hus, 2016); and (d) it provides exhaustive details on the characteristics of the publications (Donthu *et al.*, 2021). Due to these factors, Scopus has emerged as the favored platform for conducting bibliometric reviews (Donthu *et al.*, 2021).

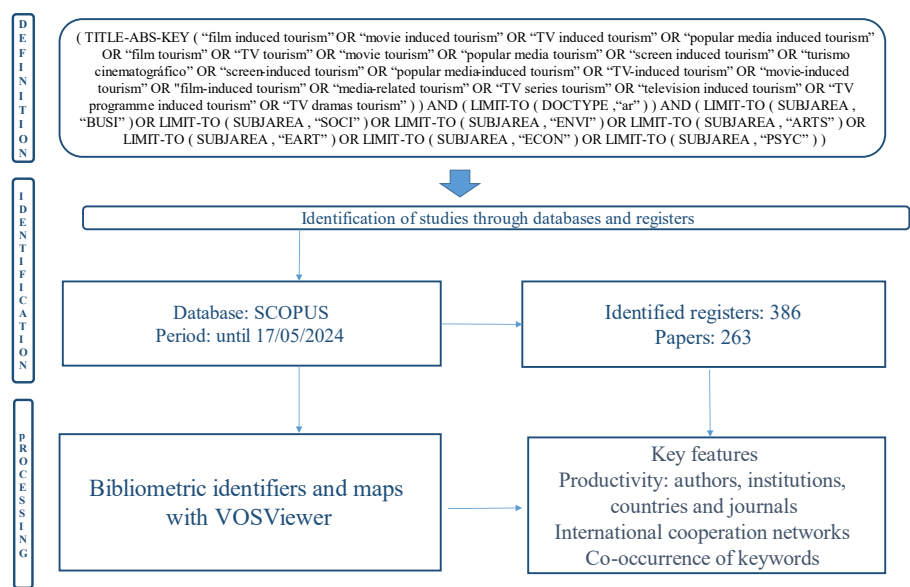


Figure 1. Methodology of applied bibliometric analysis. Source: Developed by authors

Search criteria were established to identify relevant records in the repository. Key terms were applied to the fields “title”, “abstract”, and “keywords”. Table 1 presents the terms used, document types included, and the selected publication areas.

The equation of search was as follows:

(TITLE-ABS-KEY OR “film-induced tourism” OR “movie-induced tourism” OR “screen-induced tourism” OR “screen-induced tourism” OR “popular media-induced tourism” OR “TV-induced tourism” OR “movie-induced tourism” OR “film-induced tourism” OR “media-related tourism” OR “TV series tourism” OR “television-induced tourism” OR “TV programme-induced tourism” OR “TV dramas tourism”) AND (LIMIT-TO (DOCTYPE, “ar”)) AND (LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “BUSI”) OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “SOCI”) OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “ENVI”) OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “ARTS”) OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “EART”) OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “ECON”) OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, “PSYC”)).

A total of 386 documents matching the search criteria were retrieved from Scopus on April 17, 2024. An initial filter by document type was applied, selecting only research articles due to their scientific rigor and peer-review process (Paul *et al.*, 2021). This resulted in 263 documents for analysis.

The selected records were exported and analyzed using VOSviewer v.1.6.18, a tool for generating network maps that group and visualize terms (Gálvez-Sánchez *et al.*, 2021). This enabled the examination of co-authorship, country interactions, and keyword evolution. VOSviewer, widely used in bibliometric studies (Belmonte-Ureña *et al.*, 2021), facilitated the identification of conceptual domains and their interrelations through co-citation and co-occurrence analysis.

Finally, the relationships between articles were analyzed through co-authorship and keyword co-occurrence methods. The co-authorship analysis revealed stronger conceptual links with greater collaboration among authors. The co-occurrence of keywords allowed the identification of core research themes in film-induced tourism. Lastly, previous findings were contrasted with the results of this analysis.

### 3. Results

#### 3.1 General characteristics (RQ1 and RQ2)

This section analyzes the general characteristics of the selected scientific publications, focusing on their temporal distribution, thematic areas, and document types. As of April 17,

**Table 1.** Key terms, areas and type of documents used

| Keywords                               | Area                                | Type of document |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|
| Film-induced tourism                   | Business, Management and Accounting | Articles         |
| Movie-induced tourism                  | Social Sciences                     |                  |
| Screen-induced tourism                 | Environmental Science               |                  |
| Screen-induced tourism                 | Arts and Humanities                 |                  |
| Popular media-induced tourism          | Earth and Planetary Sciences        |                  |
| TV-induced tourism                     | Economics                           |                  |
| Movie-induced tourism                  | Econometrics and Finance            |                  |
| Film-induced tourism                   | Psychology                          |                  |
| Media-related tourism                  |                                     |                  |
| TV series tourism                      |                                     |                  |
| Television-induced tourism             |                                     |                  |
| TV programme-induced tourism           |                                     |                  |
| TV dramas tourism                      |                                     |                  |
| <b>Source(s):</b> Developed by authors |                                     |                  |

2024, 386 documents had been published, with the first contributions on film-induced tourism dating back to 1998. Since then, 384 related papers have been indexed in Scopus. Figure 2 illustrates the irregular annual growth in the volume of publications.

Figure 3 displays the distribution of research articles on film-induced tourism across 18 thematic areas. The most represented fields are Business, Management and Accounting (271 articles), Social Sciences (204), Arts and Humanities (54), Economics, Econometrics and Finance (51), and Environmental Science (45), which account for 88.15% of the total. The remaining 11.85% is spread across 13 areas, highlighting the multidisciplinary nature of this research field.

Regarding the type of document published, *Articles* representing 68.5%, followed by *Book Chapters* (15.72%) and *Conference Papers* (5.7%) (see Figure 4).



Figure 2. Evolution of scientific documents. Source: Developed by authors

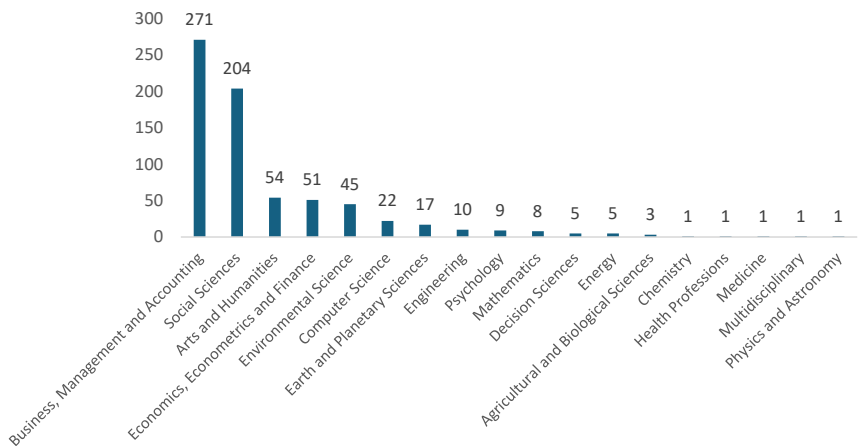
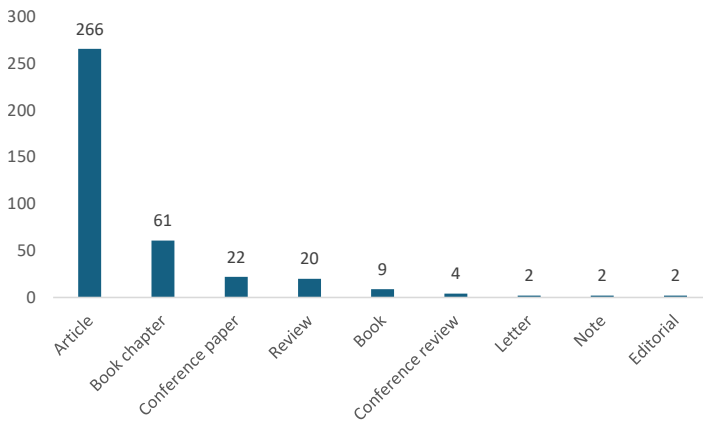


Figure 3. Documents published by thematic areas. Source: Developed by authors



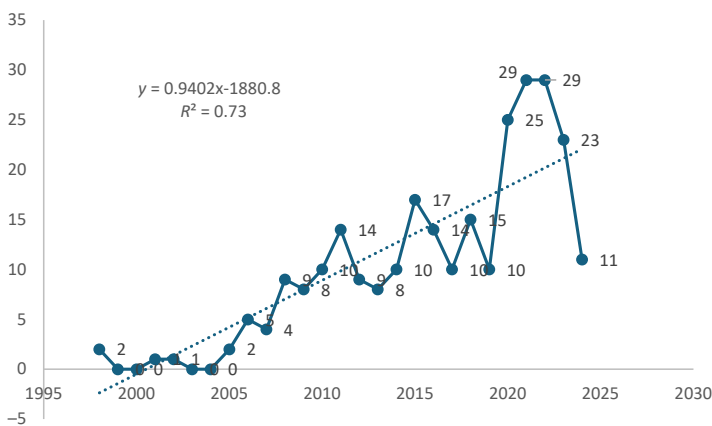
**Figure 4.** Documents published by type. Source: Developed by authors

### 3.2 Analysis of scientific production (RQ3)

In the following section, we focus exclusively on the 263 articles published within the thematic areas of *Business, Management and Accounting, Social Sciences, Environmental Science, Arts and Humanities, Earth and Planetary Sciences, Economics, Econometrics and Finance*, and *Psychology*. We analyze key bibliometric indicators related to authors, countries, institutions, collaboration networks, and journals.

**3.2.1 Evolution of scientific production.** The earliest publications on film-induced tourism date back to 1998, with two articles (see [Figure 5](#)). Although growth has been uneven, scientific interest has risen markedly since 2020. The first of the works on film-induced tourism is authored by Sargent, who explores the interconnections among various cultural industries, including heritage, museums, tourism, publications, and television. The analysis is based on audience perception and reception, drawing from the success of BBC's *Pride and Prejudice* in 1995. Riley *et al.* show the power of movies in attracting people to places, based on the analysis of 12 different locations in the United States.

**3.2.2 Most cited articles.** [Table 2](#) presents the ten most cited articles in the field, all of which confirm the positive influence of films and television series on tourism by attracting visitors to



**Figure 5.** Evolution of scientific production (articles). Source: Developed by authors

Table 2. Most cited articles

| Authors                              | Title                                                                                                    | Year | Cited by |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|----------|
| Riley R.; Baker D.; Van Doren C.S.   | Movie-induced tourism                                                                                    | 1998 | 379      |
| Hudson S.; Ritchie J.R.B.            | Promoting destinations via film tourism: An empirical identification of supporting marketing initiatives | 2006 | 332      |
| Buchmann A.; Moore K.; Fisher D.     | Experiencing Film Tourism. Authenticity and Fellowship                                                   | 2010 | 307      |
| Busby G.; Klug J.                    | Movie-induced tourism: The challenge of measurement and other issues                                     | 2001 | 292      |
| Kim S.                               | Audience involvement and film tourism experiences: Emotional places, emotional experiences               | 2012 | 236      |
| Kim S.S.; Agrusa J.; Lee H.; Chon K. | Effects of Korean television dramas on the flow of Japanese tourists                                     | 2007 | 211      |
| Lee S.; Scott D.; Kim H.             | Celebrity fan involvement and destination perceptions                                                    | 2008 | 185      |
| Connell J.                           | Toddlers, tourism and Tobermory: Destination marketing issues and television-induced tourism             | 2005 | 165      |
| Hudson S.; Wang Y.; Gil S.M.         | The influence of a film on destination image and the desire to travel: A cross-cultural comparison       | 2011 | 156      |
| Croy W.G.                            | Planning for film tourism: Active destination image management                                           | 2010 | 132      |
| Source(s): Developed by authors      |                                                                                                          |      |          |

featured locations. Although all studies focus on well-known productions, they explore diverse dimensions of the phenomenon.

Riley *et al.* (1998), with 379 citations, demonstrate that films can enhance destination appeal and significantly boost tourism, but emphasize the need for effective impact management. Hudson and Ritchie (2006) examine the benefits of film tourism and outline marketing strategies to enhance its potential. Buchmann *et al.* (2010), analyzing *The Lord of the Rings* case in New Zealand, propose a broadened concept of authenticity—objectual, existential, and embodied—within the tourist experience.

Busby and Klug (2001) place film-induced tourism within the broader context of cultural and literary tourism. Kim (2012) identifies emotional and behavioral engagement with TV dramas as key to motivating visits to filming locations. Similarly, Kim *et al.* (2007) argue that television series influence tourist perceptions and behaviors, while Lee *et al.* (2008) show how parasocial relationships with celebrities shape destination familiarity, image, and visiting intentions.

Connell (2005) addresses the emergence of 'child tourism' driven by popular TV shows and highlights the importance of managing such tourism sustainably. Hudson *et al.* (2011) reveal how films alter destination images across countries and stimulate travel intention. Lastly, Croy (2010) underscores the strategic role of destination image in leveraging film exposure for long-term tourism benefits.

3.2.3 *Productivity and international cooperation networks (RQ4).* This section presents results on the productivity of authors, institutions, countries, and journals, along with their international collaboration networks. Table 3 lists the ten most productive authors in film-induced tourism research. The most prolific is Kim (Australia), with 13 publications. Hudson (USA) has the highest citation count (692) and the highest average citations per article (138.4), followed by Kim with 47.6. The H-index of the 10 most cited authors in this field of research ranges from 11 for Kim, to 6 for Seongseop (Sam) Kim, and 2 for Nieto-Ferrando and Gómez-Morales.

**Table 3.** The 10 authors with the most published articles

| Authors              | A  | TC  | TC/A   | Institution                                                             | C             | 1st A | Last A | H index |
|----------------------|----|-----|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------|--------|---------|
| Kim, Sangkyun        | 13 | 619 | 47.62  | Edith Cowan University                                                  | Australia     | 2012  | 2023   | 11      |
| Kim, Seongseop (Sam) | 6  | 237 | 39.50  | School of Hotel and Tourism Management Hong Kong Polytechnic University | Hong Kong     | 2015  | 2019   | 6       |
| Beeton, S.           | 6  | 276 | 46.00  | University of Hokkaido                                                  | Japan         | 2006  | 2015   | 5       |
| Ryan, C.             | 5  | 103 | 20.60  | University of Waikato, Hamilton                                         | New Zealand   | 2013  | 2023   | 4       |
| Kim, Sangkyun (Sean) | 5  | 171 | 34.20  | Edith Cowan University                                                  | Australia     | 2015  | 2019   | 5       |
| Hudson, S.           | 5  | 692 | 138.40 | University of South Carolina, Carolina                                  | United States | 2006  | 2019   | 5       |
| Frost, W.            | 5  | 130 | 26.00  | La Trobe University, Melbourne                                          | Australia     | 2010  | 2015   | 4       |
| Reijnders, S.        | 4  | 30  | 7.50   | Erasmus Universiteit Rotterdam                                          | Netherlands   | 2019  | 2022   | 3       |
| Nieto-Ferrando, J.   | 4  | 25  | 6.25   | University of Lleida                                                    | Spain         | 2021  | 2023   | 2       |
| Gómez-Morales, B.    | 4  | 25  | 6.25   | University of Lleida                                                    | Spain         | 2021  | 2023   | 2       |

**Note(s):** (A): Number of articles published; (TC) Number of citations; (TC/A): Average citations per article; (C): Country; (1st A): Year of first publication; (Last A): Year of most recent publication; (Index H): IndexH in this research area

**Source(s):** Developed by authors

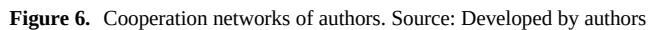
To analyze international co-authorship in film-induced tourism research, a minimum threshold of two joint publications was applied. Fourteen authors met this criterion, with Beeton emerging as the most collaborative. However, the weak connections among them reveal a limited level of international cooperation in this field (see Figure 6).

Table 4 presents the ten most productive institutions in film-induced tourism research and their international cooperation performance. The Hong Kong Polytechnic University leads with 18 publications and 740 citations, followed by Flinders University (Australia) with 12 articles and 683 citations. Sejong University (South Korea) stands out for the highest average citations per article (95.80), followed by Flinders (56.92). In terms of impact, Hong Kong Polytechnic and Flinders have the highest H-indexes, with 13 and 12, respectively.

International cooperation networks offer valuable insights into researcher interactions and knowledge dissemination (Chen *et al.*, 2019). In the cooperation maps, circle size represents the volume of publications, colors indicate clusters, and proximity reflects co-authorship frequency. Figure 7 illustrates institutional cooperation within the field. Of 449 institutions identified, 27 met the threshold of at least two publications. However, only four institutions are interconnected, forming two small clusters—one of which includes Edith Cowan University (Australia) and the Hong Kong Polytechnic University—indicating limited institutional collaboration.

Table 5 summarizes the ten most productive countries in film-induced tourism research and their collaboration networks. Australia and Spain lead in the volume of publications, with 46 and 34 articles, respectively. Australia also ranks highest in total citations (2,173), followed by the United States (1,546), which records the highest average citations per article (59.46), ahead

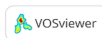
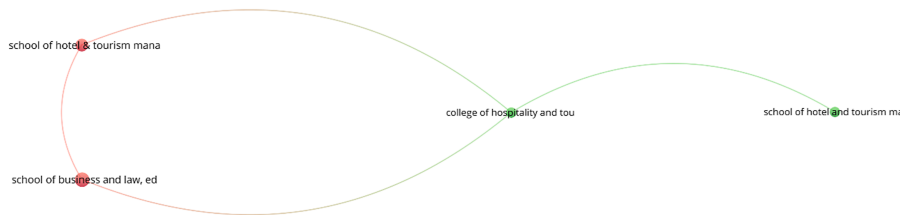




| Institution                       | C              | A  | TC  | TC/A  | H index | CI (%) | CI    | NIC   |
|-----------------------------------|----------------|----|-----|-------|---------|--------|-------|-------|
| Hong Kong Polytechnic University  | Hong Kong      | 18 | 740 | 41.11 | 13      | 77.8%  | 48.29 | 16.00 |
| Flinders University               | Australia      | 12 | 683 | 56.92 | 12      | 66.7%  | 43.25 | 84.25 |
| Edith Cowan University            | Australia      | 10 | 290 | 29.00 | 8       | 80.0%  | 33.75 | 10.00 |
| La Trobe University               | Australia      | 9  | 390 | 43.33 | 7       | 0.0%   | –     | 43.33 |
| Erasmus Universiteit Rotterdam    | Netherlands    | 8  | 37  | 4.63  | 4       | 12.5%  | 5.00  | 4.57  |
| Monash University                 | Australia      | 7  | 299 | 42.71 | 5       | 14.3%  | 88.00 | 35.17 |
| Victoria University of Wellington | New Zealand    | 6  | 168 | 28.00 | 4       | 100.0% | 28.00 | –     |
| University of Lleida              | Spain          | 6  | 45  | 7.50  | 4       | 33.3%  | 1.00  | 10.75 |
| University of Surrey              | United Kingdom | 5  | 147 | 29.40 | 4       | 80.0%  | 27.50 | 37.00 |
| Sejong University                 | South Korea    | 5  | 479 | 95.80 | 5       | 100.0% | 95.80 | –     |

**Source(s):** Developed by authors

In terms of international collaboration, the United Kingdom and Australia have the highest number of international partners (28 and 18, respectively), though most of their publications



**Figure 7.** Cooperation networks between institutions. Source: Developed by authors

**Table 5.** Top ten countries by research productivity

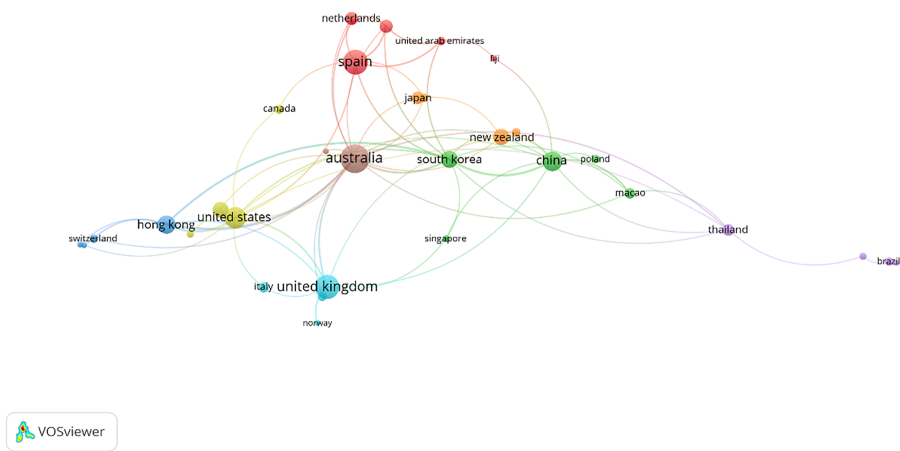
| Country        | A  | TC    | TC/A  | H index | NC | Main collaborators                                               | CI (%) | TC/A<br>3CI | NIC   |
|----------------|----|-------|-------|---------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------|-------|
| Australia      | 46 | 2,173 | 47.24 | 26      | 18 | Hong Kong, South Korea, United Kingdom                           | 43.5%  | 53.20       | 42.65 |
| Spain          | 34 | 396   | 11.65 | 9       | 8  | United States, United Kingdom, India, Singapore                  | 26.5%  | 29.89       | 5.08  |
| United Kingdom | 33 | 1,534 | 46.48 | 10      | 28 | United States, Canada, Australia, Germany                        | 39.4%  | 46.46       | 46.50 |
| United States  | 26 | 1,546 | 59.46 | 15      | 12 | Australia, Austria, Canada, China, United States, United Kingdom | 57.7%  | 65.87       | 50.73 |
| China          | 23 | 408   | 17.74 | 9       | 11 | United States, United Kingdom, China                             | 69.6%  | 16.31       | 21.00 |
| Hong Kong      | 19 | 719   | 37.84 | 13      | 7  | United States, United Kingdom, Canada, Germany                   | 63.2%  | 52.58       | 12.57 |
| South Korea    | 17 | 614   | 36.12 | 9       | 11 | United Kingdom, United States, Australia                         | 88.2%  | 39.33       | 12.00 |
| New Zealand    | 15 | 690   | 46.00 | 9       | 6  | United States, United Kingdom, Australia, Germany                | 60.0%  | 68.67       | 12.00 |
| Taiwan         | 14 | 608   | 43.43 | 11      | 2  | United States                                                    | 21.4%  | 70.00       | 36.18 |
| Portugal       | 10 | 44    | 4.40  | 3       | 6  | Slovakia, Sweden, United States                                  | 40.0%  | 2.25        | 5.83  |

**Note(s):** (A): number of articles published (TC): total citations; (TC/A): average citations per article; (NC): Number of collaborating countries; (H index): Hirst index in the research line; (CI): index cooperation; (TC/A CI): average number of citations with international cooperation; (TC/A IAS): average number of citations without international cooperation; (TCNIC): Number of citations per article without international collaboration

**Source(s):** Developed by authors

are domestically co-authored, with cooperation indexes (CI) of 39.4% and 43.5%. In contrast, South Korea (CI = 88.2%), China (69.6%), and Hong Kong (63.2%) show the highest levels of international cooperation.

Figure 8 maps international collaboration networks in film-induced tourism research. Applying a minimum threshold of two publications per country, the analysis identified 50 countries and 36 with active collaborations, forming nine networks and eight distinct clusters.



**Figure 8.** International cooperation networks between countries. Source: Developed by authors

The broad participation of countries reflects a stable and extensive international cooperation network in this field. Spain leads the largest collaboration cluster (red), comprising six countries, followed by South Korea in the green cluster with five.

Table 6 presents the ten most prolific academic journals in film-induced tourism research. The *Journal of Travel and Tourism Marketing* leads with 21 publications, followed by *Tourism Management* (12) and *Tourist Studies* (10). In terms of impact, *Annals of Tourism Research* stands out with 1,021 citations across 6 articles (170.17 citations/article), followed by *Tourism Management* with 1,202 citations (100.17/article). The highest H-index is held by *Journal of Travel and Tourism Marketing* ( $H = 13$ ), followed by *Tourism Management* ( $H = 11$ ).

**Table 6.** Top ten most prolific journal

| Journal                                          | A  | TC    | TC/A   | H index<br>articles | H index<br>journal | SJR  | C              | First<br>article | Last<br>article |
|--------------------------------------------------|----|-------|--------|---------------------|--------------------|------|----------------|------------------|-----------------|
| <i>Journal of Travel and Tourism Marketing</i>   | 21 | 693   | 33.00  | 16                  | 104                | 1.55 | United States  | 2008             | 2024            |
| <i>Tourism Management</i>                        | 12 | 1,202 | 100.17 | 11                  | 255                | 3.35 | United Kingdom | 2005             | 2024            |
| <i>Tourist Studies</i>                           | 10 | 213   | 21.30  | 7                   | 57                 | 0.92 | United Kingdom | 2007             | 2024            |
| <i>Tourism Analysis</i>                          | 8  | 189   | 23.63  | 7                   | 45                 | 0.34 | United States  | 2006             | 2019            |
| <i>Journal of Vacation Marketing</i>             | 8  | 609   | 76.13  | 8                   | 78                 | 1.32 | United Kingdom | 2001             | 2020            |
| <i>Current Issues in Tourism</i>                 | 8  | 218   | 27.25  | 6                   | 108                | 1.92 | United Kingdom | 2012             | 2023            |
| <i>Tourism Recreation Research</i>               | 6  | 90    | 15.00  | 4                   | 63                 | 0.92 | United Kingdom | 2008             | 2024            |
| <i>International Journal of Tourism Research</i> | 6  | 321   | 53.50  | 5                   | 81                 | 1.18 | United Kingdom | 2011             | 2024            |
| <i>Annals of Tourism Research</i>                | 6  | 1,021 | 170.17 | 6                   | 216                | 3.45 | United Kingdom | 1998             | 2019            |
| <i>Tourism Management Perspectives</i>           | 5  | 116   | 23.20  | 4                   | 82                 | 1.97 | United Kingdom | 2016             | 2023            |

**Source(s):** Developed by authors

### 3.3 Current research topics (RQ5)

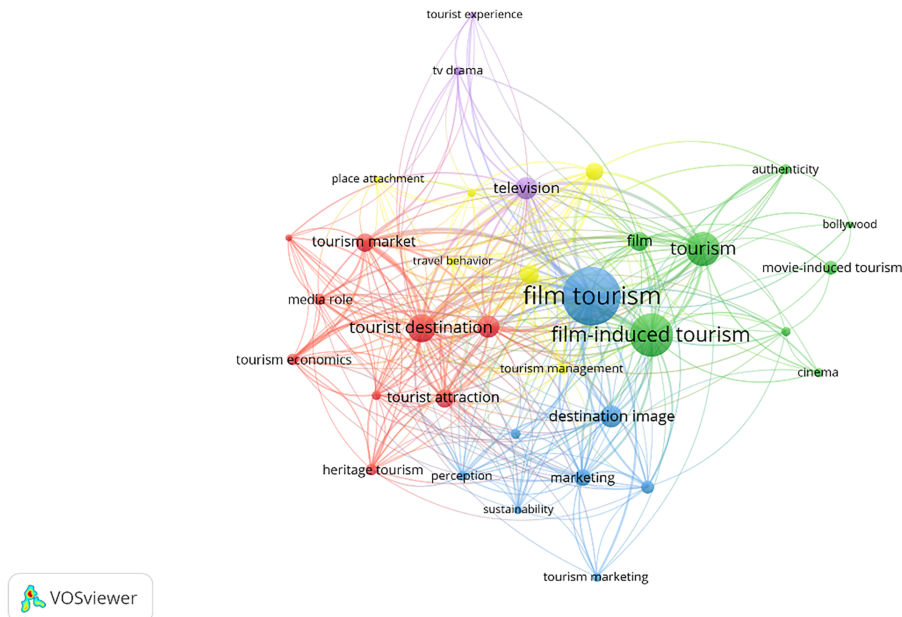
This section presents a co-occurrence analysis of keywords in film-induced tourism research up to April 2024, aiming to visualize thematic trends. Based on the principle that shared keywords indicate conceptual similarity (Weinberg, 1974), we applied VOSviewer, which constructs a keyword matrix by calculating frequencies (Park and Nagy, 2018). From 263 articles, 962 keywords were identified; applying a minimum of five co-occurrences and filtering out irrelevant terms, 34 keywords remained and were grouped into five clusters (see Figure 9).

Figure 10 illustrates the evolution of keyword clusters over time. Interest in the topic grew notably from the early 2000s, with the green and blue clusters experiencing exponential growth since 2005–2007, becoming the main drivers of the field. In contrast, the red, yellow, and violet clusters remained stable. Research trends increasingly focus on film shootings, tourist behavior, and the impact of TV series. The dominant clusters center on tourist motivations, visitor profiles, and marketing strategies—especially the influence of audiovisual productions on destination image (blue cluster) and the factors driving visits to film locations (green cluster).

**3.3.1 Red cluster. The tourist destination, filming location.** The red cluster consists of 9 keywords (*heritage tourism, international tourism, mass media, media role, tourism development, tourism economics, tourism market, tourist attraction, tourist destination*) being the tourist destination the driving force of the publications.

This cluster comprises 58 articles, with the most cited works highlighting how successful films and series filmed in specific locations contribute to sustained tourism growth. These studies confirm that audiovisual productions serve as powerful promotional tools, significantly influencing both the local economy and the cultural perceptions of destinations.

Early authors such as Riley *et al.* (1998) and Connell (2005) demonstrate that movies increase visits to film locations. Hudson and Ritchie (2006) identify film tourism as an important economic driver and propose a model for exploiting marketing opportunities in this



**Figure 9.** Clusters concerning film-induced tourism. Source: Developed by authors

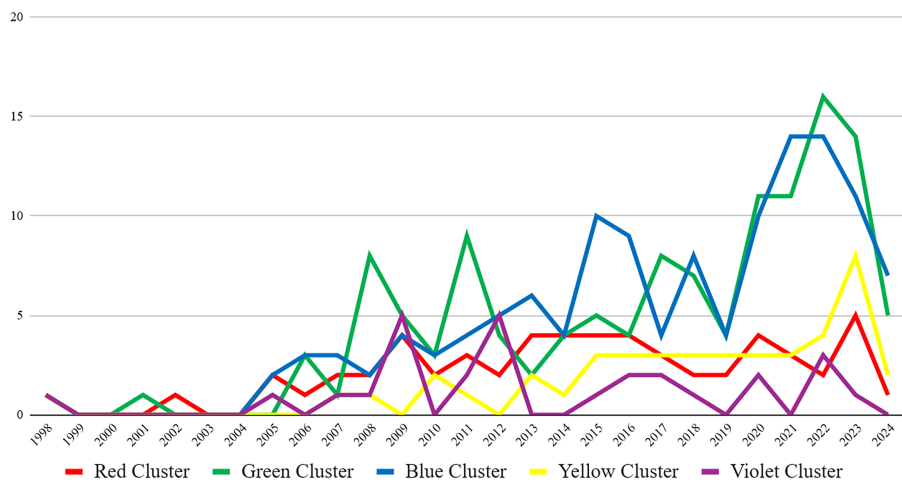


Figure 10. Evolution of clusters in the analysis of film-induced tourism. Source: Developed by authors

sector, emphasizing the need for proactive strategies by Destination Marketing Organizations (DMO). Kim et al. (2007) study the way popular Korean series in Japan have improved Korea’s image and increased Japanese tourism, benefiting relations between the two countries.

More recent works, such as Lee et al. (2008) and Hudson et al. (2011), discuss how celebrities and movies shape tourist perception and can be used strategically to attract tourists. Fu et al. (2016) add that audience engagement and destination perception are crucial for tourism promotion.

Hao et al. (2024) focus on the way physical space and media representations intertwine to create a unique tourist experience. In their study, they analyze how a destination in China has been transformed into a symbolic tourist destination through its association with the film *Avatar*. Local actions, such as renaming the park’s physical features to align them with the film, have played a crucial role in creating a symbolic space that attracts tourists, showing how destination management can use media and popular culture to boost tourist interest. While the use of the *Avatar* image has increased tourism, it also poses challenges in terms of maintaining the authenticity and sustainability of the destination. Destination management must balance leveraging the commercial appeal of such media partnerships with preserving the cultural and natural integrity of the site.

Cobeña et al. (2024) argue that film tourism can revitalize economically declining rural areas and that residents’ attitude towards tourism are key to economic development, while Nakayama (2023) evaluates the applicability of Pearce et al. (2003) to film tourism, proposing a sixth stage that addresses sustainability and the problem of overtourism.

3.3.2 Green cluster. Motivations and profile of the cinematographic tourist. The green cluster comprises 8 keywords (*authenticity, Bollywood, cinema, film-induced tourism, movie-induced tourism, product placement, tourism*), with *film-induced tourism* identified as the primary driver behind this group’s 124 publications. These studies explore tourist motivations and profiles over time. Florido-Benítez (2023) investigates the connection between film-induced tourism and theme park visitation, revealing that iconic film characters and narratives serve as powerful marketing tools, conferring notable benefits to society, the film industry, and tourist destinations. Zhang et al. (2023) examine how film-driven destination imagery influences tourists’ intentions to engage in heritage conservation, with perceived authenticity and the heritage image functioning as crucial mediators. Moritz et al. (2024) frame film tourism as a dynamic and fast-growing branch of creative tourism, noting that young, venture

some tourists often integrate visits to film sites into broader travel itineraries, as shown in a Slovakian case study. [Alvarado-Sizzo et al. \(2024\)](#) focus on the emotional motivations behind film tourism, particularly nostalgia and familial ties, describing the phenomenon as a form of “media pilgrimage”. Lastly, [Pessina \(2024\)](#) applies a netnographic approach to reveal how video content shapes viewer perceptions of destinations and their cultural attributes, emphasizing the role of digital media in promoting tourism and cultural enhancement.

**3.3.3 Blue cluster: Destination image and tourism marketing.** The blue cluster consists of 8 keywords (*destination image, destination marketing, film tourism, marketing, perception, popular culture, Sustainability, tourism marketing*), with *film tourism* as research driving force. This cluster consists of 128 articles. These works collectively illustrate the complex interplay among media, cultural perception and tourism, highlighting the significant influence of media content on the global tourism industry.

Recent studies on film tourism and its impact on tourism perception and behavior underline how digital technologies and media can shape travelers’ experience and decisions. Thus, [Schiafone and Brandellero \(2024\)](#) discuss the way film tourism applications and movie maps in Scotland not only guide tourists but also allow them to interact with filming locations in a more personal and immersive way, redefining the tourist experience through a fusion of physical and media realities.

[Kim et al. \(2024\)](#) discover that exposure to negative content on Netflix can lead to unfavorable perceptions of a destination, in contrast to the positive effects of friendly or promotional content. [Yen et al. \(2024\)](#) show that engagement with film tourism enhances tourists’ subjective well-being, especially through memorable tourist experiences. [Azevedo et al. \(2023\)](#) warn of the negative effects of violent and bloody crime series on the image of tourist destinations, indicating that such depictions can significantly deter intentions to visit those places. Finally, [Kim \(2012\)](#) discusses how popular Korean series have improved the image of Korea in Japan, resulting in an increase in tourism that benefits both countries economically and socio-culturally.

**3.3.4 Yellow cluster: tourists’ behavior towards film destinations.** The yellow cluster includes 6 keywords (*film industry, involvement, place attachment, tourism management, tourist behavior, travel behavior*), with *tourist behavior* at the center of the research. It comprises 44 articles examining how cinematic representations and motivations influence tourists’ perceptions and behavior toward film-related destinations. [Jørgensen and Reichenberger \(2023\)](#) analyze negative tourist behavior through the framework of moral disengagement, suggesting that the moral alignment of the TV series and situational contexts jointly influence tourists’ justification of inappropriate actions. [Buchmann et al. \(2010\)](#) explore the roles of authenticity, existential authenticity, sincerity, and hyperreality, concluding that film tourists are in search of meaningful, authentic experiences shaped by both physical settings and social interactions. [Carl et al. \(2007\)](#) argue that the more accurate the recreation of hyperreality in visits to film location, the higher the satisfaction and quality of tourist experiences. They also note that some tourists actively recreate iconic film scenes, highlighting the importance of cultural landscape perception for tour operators and destination managers. [Lee et al. \(2008\)](#) provide both theoretical and empirical insights on how celebrity influence shapes destination perception, and suggest that leveraging celebrity appeal, particularly among fan communities, can be highly beneficial for tourism marketing.

**3.3.5 Violet cluster: TV series and their influence on tourism.** The violet cluster includes 3 keywords (*TV, tourist experience, TV drama*) and 28 articles. [Nieto-Ferrando et al. \(2023\)](#) conduct a literature review on the influence of films and series on tourism from the perspective of audience analysis, identifying a lack of integration between media and tourism studies, and proposing a greater incorporation of audience reception in tourism research. [Nunes \(2022\)](#) provides a systematic review of film-induced tourism, underlining its growing relevance and benefits to media-featured destinations, while also calling for more robust methodologies and balanced management of its impacts. [Gómez-Morales et al. \(2022\)](#) explore how the scenic beauty and plot narratives in *Game of Thrones* enhance tourist experiences, finding a positive

correlation between the frequency and duration of scenes in Spanish locations and tourist engagement on social networks. [Kim and Kim \(2021\)](#) examine how the perceived value of K-dramas, audience involvement, and character attachment influence behavioral intentions to visit filming sites, concluding that narrative and emotional factors outweigh the visual appeal of locations. Similarly, [Su et al. \(2011\)](#) reveal that parasocial relationships and viewers' attitudes toward characters in Korean dramas significantly shape perceptions of filming locations, especially among viewers who perceive a strong cultural proximity to Korea.

## 4. Discussions and conclusions

### 4.1 Conclusions

This work has focused on audiovisual fiction as a means of tourist induction to know the evolution of the researchers' interest in this field. A detailed study of the keywords used by academic research reveals the existence of two main clusters, which have investigated the importance of tourist motivations and profiles induced by the audiovisual medium, as well as the configuration of the brand image of tourist destinations displayed on screen, confirming the theoretical advance model proposed by [Beeton \(2011\)](#). Images, as advanced by [Guthrie and Gale \(1991\)](#) are more relevant than tangible advertising, since it is the perceptions they provoke and the messages they contain that motivate consumers' actions. In this sense, [Beeton \(2006\)](#) has also argued that, since the last third of the 20th century, cinema has been the main vehicle of access to mass audiences, influencing their travel decisions. Our work confirms the importance of the audiovisual media as an image inducing and motivating element for potential tourists during the period 1998–2024.

As for the topics of greatest interest for film-induced tourism researchers, the review of the ten most cited articles reinforces the idea that cinema (series and films) can have a positive influence on the travel industry, with a proven increase in visitors wishing to experience the locations they have seen on screen. The results, in line with those by [Afshardoost and Eshaghi \(2020\)](#), [Cabuyao et al. \(2023\)](#), [Chen \(2023\)](#), [Darson et al. \(2024\)](#), [Sharma et al. \(2022\)](#), or [Zhang and Lo \(2024\)](#), thus verify the researchers' interest in discovering how cinema, television and now digital platforms have a real impact on travel motivations by familiarizing viewers with destination images shown on screen.

### 4.2 Theoretical implications

From the analysis carried out it can be concluded that the film-induced tourism research line is relatively recent, with the first research works emerging in 1998. Moments of growth can be detected after the generation of methodological advances linked to the analysis of the reception of certain products ([Lee et al., 2008](#); [Kim, 2010](#); [Kim and O'Connor, 2011](#)) or with the emergence of themes related to the configuration of the brand image of destinations ([Jones and Smith, 2005](#)). Moreover, although the interest in understanding tourist motivations emerged from the beginning (initial period, 1998–2004), it was not until the second period (2005–2014) when researchers decided to address the configuration of the tourist image on screen (especially, after successful cases, such as *Lord of the Rings*, 2001–2003), clearly dominating the trends of the third period (2015–2024).

At the same time, 18 thematic areas related to film-induced tourism have been identified, so we can affirm that the object of study has been approached from a multidisciplinary perspective throughout the period 1998–2024. This gives an idea of the importance accorded to the research line, capable of simultaneously impacting different areas and, as [Beeton \(2011\)](#) predicts, has become a more in-depth and postmodern investigation from a multidisciplinary perspective. However, only five thematic areas concentrate the largest volume of scientific production: Social Sciences, Business, Management and Accounting; Arts and Humanities; Economics, Econometrics and Finance; and Environmental Sciences. These areas account for 88.15% of the published documents.



Furthermore, and despite being a topic addressed in a multidisciplinary way, there is a lack of connection and international cooperation between authors and institutions working on the topic, which seems to corroborate [Connell's \(2012\)](#) recommendations concerning interdisciplinarity, a shortcoming that persists, as verified by [Puche-Ruiz et al. \(2024\)](#): of the 245 authors who do research in the line, only 14 have been found to do so in cooperation with others. Therefore, it is considered of great interest to propose future research that analyzes the main factors influencing this lack of international cooperation. Factors such as legislation, funding sources, language barriers, geographical disparities, among others, may be slowing down or favoring collaboration between international researchers.

In terms of institutions, the most productive are Hong Kong Polytechnic University and the Australian Flinders University. Yet, as with authors at the individual level, there is a lack of international connection. Although there are 449 institutions involved in the analysis of film-induced tourism, only 4 cooperate forming two clusters. Australia and Spain are the most productive countries, but the United Kingdom and Australia are by far the countries with the highest number of international collaborators (at the domestic level) and South Korea, China and Hong Kong at the level of cooperation with other countries.

#### 4.3 Practical implications

Regarding the practical implications, the research reviewed focuses on the analysis of destination placement marketing only. In this regard, the work by [Hao et al. \(2024\)](#), which focuses exclusively on how place attachment and involvement affect the intention to travel, suggests that future research should broaden the range of destination placement marketing strategies and evaluate the applicability of the model they have proposed. In addition, they point to the need to compare the effects of different types of placement marketing. In this sense, and according to [Zhou et al. \(2023\)](#), it is essential to advance comparative studies and new research that consider different types of destinations for film tourism; as well as to delve into the possible cultural differences between destinations. Finally, considering that their study focuses on the effect of celebrity involvement, destination image and place attachment on tourist loyalty, other variables, such as tourism activities, self-congruence, emotional solidarity, perceived environment and demographic factors (e.g. age, gender, income level) should be considered as factors that may affect the relationships between the variables in film-induced tourism.

Therefore, future research should incorporate more predictive variables such as satisfaction and experiential value, which would allow for the development of more complete models by scholars and a better understanding of the effects of destination placement by Film Commissions and DMO. In the same line is manifested [Chen \(2023\)](#). For example, there is a need for extensive research on how the appearance of destinations in audiovisual products, which does not correspond to reality, can affect aspects such as the intention to travel, and how, after visiting the destination, these differences between the image created (as a result of viewing) and the actual image of the destination can affect the tourist's experience and satisfaction.

The fact that this line of research has developed around the analysis of the marketing actions of tourist destinations, as well as on the understanding of the different profiles of film tourists may indicate that both Academia and DMO have been working in parallel, duplicating efforts in understanding the phenomenon. In this sense, cooperation between the two is essential, while it would also be interesting to involve the Film Commissions, so that they could try, not only to promote specific tourism segments, but also to protect, to the extent of their possibilities, the image that production companies promote of tourist destinations. The proliferation of studies on spoofing locations in recent years shows a growing concern about these practices on the part of all the entities involved ([Aertsen et al., 2022](#)), and are also consistent with the postmodern perspectives envisaged by [Beeton \(2011\)](#) onwards.



On the other hand, and according to [Nieto-Ferrando et al. \(2023\)](#), research on how audiovisual fiction affects tourism calls for an interdisciplinary approach that combines Tourism and Media Studies, especially in relation to audience analysis, also making collaboration between Media scholars and DMO mandatory. They perceive that there is a serious lack of studies linking the film exposure of destinations and the success of film-induced tourism motivation, which has only recently gained prominence. The authors conclude that it is crucial to reconsider the relationship between audiovisual content and its impact on audiences, considering variables such as gender, interests and intercultural reception, and including narrative transportation and spectator participation.

In this vein, a more in-depth knowledge of the “cultural affinity” concept fostered by streaming production companies would be necessary, as well as coordination with DMO at the national and transnational level. “Cultural affinity” is expected to be a key concept in the future in order to shape a fair destination image and promote appreciation of tangible and intangible heritage and sustainable tourism practices, as a greater respect for the environment and efforts to reduce tourism seasonality ([UNWTO-Netflix, 2021](#)), boosting the economic growth of tourist destinations through SGDs 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), 16 (Peace and Justice) and 17 (Partnerships for the Goals).

#### 4.4 Limitations and future research lines

After having analyzed the evolution of the research lines and current trends, we can conclude that future research lines to be developed will be mainly based on two fields, which are also aligned with the projections of [Beeton \(2011\)](#), regarding the future prominence of Media Studies, Sociology or Visual Anthropology:

- (1) *Placement marketing*, investigating how the impacts of placement marketing vary depending on the type and context in which it is implemented and providing a more nuanced understanding of which strategies are most effective and under what circumstances.
- (2) *Methodologies*, investigating the applicability of models from other disciplines and expanding the analysis and effect of new predictive variables such as cultural differences, demographic factors, etc. Finally, employing longitudinal methodologies for the analysis of the effects of the implemented strategies.

In this sense, according to [Moritz et al. \(2024\)](#), there are several future research lines focusing on the film industry. These include the need to advance longitudinal studies to measure the long-term effects of the influence of films and series on tourism, as well as explain more precisely the degree of complementarity or additionality of film tourism with other branches of tourism within the culture and creative industries.

In conclusion, the following research topics can be proposed from the analysis of the clusters:

From the analysis of the red cluster, the following research topics emerged:

- (1) Deepen the understanding of how film tourism impacts the local economy and cultural perceptions in the long term, especially in lesser-known destinations.
- (2) Investigate proactive marketing models that DMO can adopt to maximize the benefits of film tourism.
- (3) Explore how destinations can balance the commercial appeal of film tourism with the need to maintain the authenticity and sustainability of the location.
- (4) Study how audience engagement and destination perception influence the decision to visit filming locations.

- (5) Analyze the potential of film tourism to revitalize rural areas and how the attitude of residents can influence this process.

From the analysis of the green cluster, the following research topics emerged:

- (1) Investigate further how film-induced tourism affects the local economy and cultural perceptions in the long term, especially in emerging destinations.
- (2) Develop and evaluate innovative marketing models that DMO can adopt to maximize the benefits of film tourism.
- (3) Explore how destinations can balance the commercial appeal of film tourism with the need to maintain authenticity and heritage conservation.
- (4) Study in depth the profiles and motivations of film tourists to better understand their expectations and behaviors.
- (5) Analyze the impact of emerging technologies on the perception of destinations and tourism promotion.

From the analysis of the blue cluster, the following research topics emerged:

- (1) Investigate how emerging digital technologies can enhance the tourist experience and destination perception; explore the effects of both negative and positive media content on destination perception and how this influences travel decisions.
- (2) Analyze how film tourism can contribute to the subjective well-being of tourists and what factors make experiences memorable.
- (3) Examine how destinations can sustainably manage film tourism to balance commercial appeal with cultural and natural preservation.
- (4) Study how popular culture can be strategically used in tourism marketing to attract different segments of tourists.

From the analysis of the yellow cluster, the following research topics emerged:

- (1) Explore how concepts of authenticity and hyperreality affect tourist satisfaction and experiences in film destinations.
- (2) Analyze the impact of celebrities.
- (3) Study how social interactions and the physical environment during travel influence film tourists' experiences and perceptions.
- (4) Examine how media representations and movie-related motivations influence travel decisions and tourist behavior.

From the analysis of the violet cluster, the following research topics emerged:

- (1) Investigate ways to better integrate audience analysis into tourism studies to better understand the reception and interaction of viewers with audiovisual content.
- (2) Develop and apply more robust research methodologies to address the benefits and challenges of film-induced tourism.
- (3) Explore how scenic beauty and narrative plot representations in TV series influence the tourist experience and visitor engagement.
- (4) Examine how parasocial relationships and cultural proximity between viewers and TV characters affect attitudes toward filming locations.

The implementation of the proposed research lines and recommendations faces several challenges. Chief among them is the limited international collaboration between researchers and institutions, hindered by language barriers, methodological differences, and a lack of incentives for network building. Applying interdisciplinary models, particularly from marketing and the social sciences, requires adaptation to the specific context of film-induced tourism. Moreover, conducting longitudinal studies, which are vital for assessing long-term impacts, as we have noticed, demands substantial resources.

Another significant obstacle is the mismatch between media portrayals of destinations and their real-life attributes, which can lead to tourist dissatisfaction and impact destination perception. DMO must therefore strike a balance between media-driven promotion and the preservation of authenticity and sustainability. However, fragmented coordination between tourism bodies, film producers, and film commissions complicates the implementation of coherent strategies, given their divergent goals.

Additionally, the limited research on the actual influence of media exposure on tourist motivations restricts comprehensive understanding. Bridging tourism and media studies through interdisciplinary approaches is essential but methodologically complex. Lastly, commercial pressures often overshadow efforts to promote sustainable film tourism practices.

To address these issues, future efforts should prioritize international cooperation, methodological adaptation, and the development of predictive models that consider cultural and contextual differences. Strengthening collaboration among stakeholders in tourism, film, and media studies will be key to ensuring coherent strategies that respect destination identity while advancing the field of film-induced tourism.

This study presents several limitations that should be considered in future research. First, the analysis relies exclusively on data retrieved from the Scopus database. Although Scopus offers broad disciplinary coverage, it has notable constraints. Specifically, it has been criticized for its linguistic bias and the underrepresentation of non-English language publications, particularly from developing countries (Mongeon and Paul-Hus, 2016). Furthermore, Scopus coverage varies by discipline, with stronger representation in health sciences and engineering, and relatively weaker inclusion of publications in the humanities and social sciences (Martín-Martín *et al.*, 2018; Mongeon and Paul-Hus, 2016). Additionally, Scopus may omit high-quality research not indexed in its database due to its inclusion criteria (Vera-Baceta *et al.*, 2019), potentially limiting the comprehensiveness of the findings. Lastly, its temporal coverage is more limited than that of databases such as Web of Science, with incomplete data for publications prior to 1996 (Martín-Martín *et al.*, 2021). However, in the present case, this limitation does not affect the analysis, as the earliest relevant studies on film-induced tourism date from 1998.

Second, this study focuses exclusively on research articles, which may overlook other valuable scholarly contributions. Future research could incorporate additional document types, such as book chapters and conference proceedings, which often contain emerging ideas not yet reflected in journal publications (Aksnes *et al.*, 2019; Wang and Barabási, 2021).

Third, the visualization and clustering of bibliometric data were conducted using VOSviewer. While this tool is widely used and effective, alternative software such as Gephi or CiteSpace may provide complementary analytical approaches and generate different clustering structures (Cobo *et al.*, 2011).

Finally, it is important to acknowledge the temporal limitations of citation-based bibliometric indicators, as citations accrue over time. Consequently, integrating bibliometric methods with content analysis could offer a more comprehensive assessment of research dynamics and impact (Aria and Cuccurullo, 2017).

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